

■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, August 24, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■■ Solar's on track to rule the world's power grid

The Angle: A new energy forecast says solar becomes the planet's #1 power source by 2032, with battery storage as the real game-changer behind it - a story with real pocketbook and climate implications for everyone, not just energy nerds.

- New projection: **solar power** becomes the **world's largest power generator by 2032**
- **Battery storage** is flagged as the single biggest driver making that shift possible
- Forecast describes a "**much changed**" global energy picture just six years out

The Debate Starter

- Six years from now solar's #1 worldwide - are you actually speeding up your own switch, or waiting it out?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://reneweconomy.com.au/solar-will-be-largest-power-generator-in-much-changed-world-by-2032-but-battery-storage-is-the-big-mover/?utm_source=substack&utm_medium=email

■■ Indiana Planned Parenthood can now refer patients out of state

The Angle: This is the next chapter in the post-Roe abortion fight — a ruling that lets an Indiana clinic point patients toward abortion access across state lines, right in the middle of the national tug-of-war over how far states can go to restrict care.

- **Planned Parenthood of Indiana** has been cleared to refer patients seeking abortions to providers **outside the state**.
- Indiana is one of several states with tight abortion restrictions since **Roe v. Wade** was overturned, making this ruling part of a bigger national pattern.

The Debate Starter

- Should clinics in states with abortion bans be allowed to send patients across state lines for care — call in and tell us where you land.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://indianacapitalchronicle.com/2026/08/19/planned-parenthood-can-refer-indiana-abortion-patients-out-of-state-federal-appeals-court-rules/>

■ Tiny Bulgaria just became the world's battery boss

The Angle: A country most people couldn't find on a map went from basically zero battery storage to leading the entire planet at storing sun for the evening rush — and it's part of a bigger story: solar just hit a record share of global electricity.

- **Bulgaria** had almost no battery storage back in **2023**
- Now solar and batteries cover **24%** of Bulgaria's electricity demand during the **7-9pm** evening peak
- That makes Bulgaria the **world leader** in shifting solar power into evening hours
- Globally, solar hit a record **10%** of all electricity generated in **2026**

The Underdog Angle

- A small Eastern European country just out-innovated the big energy players — who's the last place you'd expect to be leading the world at something?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://ember-energy.org/latest-insights/batteries-have-unlocked-the-era-of-anytime-solar/>

■ **Data Centers Get Tax Breaks, Your Neighbors Get the Bill**

The Angle: *It's the AI boom colliding with your property tax bill - data centers popping up everywhere are landing sweetheart tax deals while local homeowners quietly cover the shortfall, and this fight is playing out in suburbs all over the country right now.*

- Data centers near **O'Hare Airport** reportedly locked in almost **\$100 million** in local tax breaks
- The gap left behind doesn't just disappear - it reportedly shifts onto **suburban homeowners'** property tax bills
- It's part of a bigger nationwide pattern: towns courting the **AI data center boom** with incentives, then residents finding out who actually foots the bill

The Debate Starter

- Would you take a new data center in your town if it meant your own property taxes went up to cover its tax break?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.chicagotribune.com/2026/08/23/special-report-data-centers-taxes/>

■ **Your Robot Taxi Might Be Filming Your Front Yard**

The Angle: *Waymo's self-driving cars are loaded with cameras that keep rolling even when the vehicle is just sitting parked on a street - and that's got people online realizing their whole block could be getting recorded without anyone asking. It's the kind of quiet privacy creep that blows up once people actually notice it.*

- The claim, circulating on **Reddit's r/technology**, is that parked **Waymo** vehicles keep their cameras active - not just while driving passengers.
- Waymo's cars are covered in sensors and cameras for self-driving, meaning any idle time on your street could still be capturing footage of houses, driveways, and people coming and going.

The Debate Starter

- Would it bother you if a parked self-driving car outside your house was quietly recording everything?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.gadgetreview.com/across-nashville-parked-waymos-are-recording-your-neighborhood>

Backup options:

■ **Abbott: Data Centers 'Dug Their Own Grave'**

The Angle: *Texas Gov. Greg Abbott is throwing shade at data centers right as the AI power-grid fight goes national — electric bills and blackouts are becoming a real kitchen-table issue, and a sitting governor calling out big tech is a guaranteed debate starter.*

- **Texas Gov. Greg Abbott** says data centers have '**dug their own grave**'
- Comes amid a heated national debate over AI data centers straining power grids and driving up electric bills

The Debate Starter

- Is Abbott right that data centers brought this on themselves, or is he just deflecting on Texas's grid problems?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.businessinsider.com/greg-abbott-texas-data-centers-backlash-2026-8>

■ **Peter Thiel just admitted the quiet part about monopolies**

The Angle: *Palantir's billionaire co-founder basically confessed that every dominant company lies about facing 'real competition' - a rare moment of a tech titan saying out loud what critics have accused Big Tech of for years.*

- **Peter Thiel**, co-founder of **Palantir** and **PayPal**, said: "**Anyone that has a monopoly will pretend that they're in incredible competition.**"

- The quote is being read as Thiel exposing how tech giants publicly downplay their market dominance while privately locking out rivals.
- Thiel has long argued in his own writing (see his book '**Zero to One**') that building a monopoly is the actual goal of successful startups - this quote reads as him saying the quiet part out loud.

The Debate Starter

- Which company do you think is the biggest monopoly hiding in plain sight - Amazon, Google, or Ticketmaster?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.techradar.com/pro/quote-of-the-day-by-palantir-co-founder-peter-thiel-anyone-that-has-a-monopoly-will-pretend-that-they-re-in-incredible-competition-exposing-how-tech-titans-bend-the-market-in-their-favour>

■ **Canada Throws Another Elbow at Trump — Again**

The Angle: *The US-Canada tariff standoff keeps flaring up, and this editorial cartoon making the rounds on Reddit's r/canada is basically Canadians cheering their own government for not backing down from Trump — a storyline with real cross-border resonance for a North American audience.*

The Debate Starter

- Is Canada's tough-guy stance against Trump smart strategy or just symbolic chest-thumping that won't move the needle?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://i.redd.it/hhfqe9mwr6lh1.jpeg>

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

🇺🇸 ■ **Canadians are literally crowdfunding an MP a one-way flight out**

The Angle: *A grassroots fundraiser aimed at buying Conservative MP Jamil Jivani a one-way ticket to the US is blowing up online, and it taps into a real vein of frustration with politicians seen as too cozy with American politics — perfect petty-but-pointed Canadian content.*

The Debate Starter

- Would you chip in to ship a politician you don't like across the border, or is this just Canadians being Canadians about it?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.thebeaverton.com/2026/08/canadians-chip-in-to-buy-jamil-jivani-a-one-way-ticket-to-united-states/>

■ **Japan's Yamashita never trails, runs away with Canada's Women's Open**

The Angle: *A wire-to-wire win is the rarest kind of dominant in golf - lead from round one, never look back - and it happened right here on Canadian soil in Edmonton.*

- **Miyu Yamashita**, 25, of Japan, led from start to finish at the **CPKC Women's Open**
- It's her **4th career LPGA Tour victory** - and her **2nd win this year alone**
- The dominant performance played out at **Royal Mayfair Club** in **Edmonton**

The Watercooler Take

- Wire-to-wire wins are rare in golf - is a start-to-finish runaway more impressive to watch than a down-to-the-wire finish?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/sports/golf/japan-s-yamashita-captures-cpkc-womens-open-9.7317799?cmp=rss>

■ **Brace yourselves — a 'Godzilla' El Niño is back and it's not messing around**

The Angle: Scientists say this year's fires and heat waves weren't El Niño's fault — but the newly returned 'super' El Niño is about to scramble weather patterns across the globe, which means the wild stuff might just be getting started.

- Scientists are calling it a '**Super**' or '**Godzilla**' El Niño — the strongest flavor of this Pacific Ocean warming pattern.
- It's a **naturally occurring** phenomenon, but it disrupts weather patterns **worldwide**.
- Experts say it did **not** cause this year's fires and heat waves — those already happened without it.
- Officials are warning of a '**wild ride**' ahead as the pattern kicks into gear.

The Debate Starter

- Ask listeners: have you already noticed the weather acting weird this year — and are you ready for it to get weirder?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/climate/el-nino-2026-extreme-weather-9.7313170?cmp=rss>

Backup options:

■ This Quebec town is retraining itself for dementia

The Angle: It's a feel-good, forward-thinking story with a real human core - a whole town teaching shopkeepers, city workers and even 911 responders how to actually help someone mid-confusion instead of panicking or brushing them off.

- The initiative trains **local merchants, municipal employees, and emergency responders** to recognize and respond to dementia.
- Goal is to make everyday errands and interactions easier for **people living with dementia**.
- Part of a broader push to build a "**dementia-friendly community**" in the town.

The Human Side

- Ever had a stranger step in to help someone who was clearly confused or lost in public - and wished more people knew how?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/quebec-town-dementia-friendly-9.7313310?cmp=rss>

■ Tariffs just wiped out a Manitoba honey farm's customer base

The Angle: This is the trade war finally landing on regular people - not a big corporation, but a small family farm in rural Manitoba that just watched its main customer base disappear overnight because of U.S. tariffs.

- **Osee Podolsky**, general manager of **Podolski Honey Farms** in **Ethelbert, Man.**, says the family business is reeling
- The **vast majority** of the farm's honey used to ship straight to customers across the **United States**
- Podolsky's blunt assessment: "**Effectively, we're out of business**"

The Real-World Fallout

- This is what 'trade war' actually looks like on the ground - a family farm, not a headline, taking the hit.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/canada-us-tariff-manitoba-reaction-9.7316905?cmp=rss>

■ They evacuated the wildfire — and came home to looters

The Angle: This isn't just a break-in story — it's a betrayal-of-trust story. An entire town emptied out on an evacuation order, trusting the system to keep their homes safe, and instead came back to find people used that window to ransack houses. That's the kind of story that makes every evacuee wonder what they're really coming home to.

- **Mira Boucher** says her home in **Summerland, B.C.** was ransacked while she was under a wildfire evacuation order
- She says she feels **"violated"** by what happened
- Every single house in the community was vacant at the time — the whole town was empty under the evacuation order
- The looting happened while residents were relying on authorities to keep the evacuated zone secure

The Trust Breaker

- If you had to evacuate tonight, would you trust your neighborhood to still be standing when you got back?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/wildfire-evacuation-robbery-summerland-9.7317262?cmp=rss>

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ **Brazilian Indie 'Our Secret' Just Took Home Best Picture**

The Angle: A female filmmaker just won the top prize at one of Latin America's biggest film festivals — a nice underdog, indie-cinema win worth a quick shoutout for the film buffs in the audience.

- **Grace Passô's** film **'Our Secret'** won the **Best Film Kikito** — the top honor at the festival
- The win came at the **54th Gramado Film Festival**, one of the largest film festivals in Latin America
- The award is named the **'Kikito'** — the festival's signature trophy

The Fun Fact Hook

- Quick trivia beat: ask listeners if they can guess what a 'Kikito' award even is before you tell them.

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://x.com/Variety/status/2091567771595190510>

■ **That Coyote movie WB tried to bury? It's actually in theaters now**

The Angle: This is the ultimate Hollywood plot twist - a finished movie got shelved and basically declared dead, fans revolted, and now three years later it's actually hitting theaters. It's a great 'you can't kill a good story' underdog angle listeners will want to weigh in on.

- **'Coyote vs. Acme'** was shelved by **Warner Bros.** back in 2023 before ever reaching theaters.
- The movie is now officially opening in theaters **this week** - three years after being pulled.
- It became a symbol of studios scrapping finished films for business reasons instead of releasing them.

The Underdog Comeback

- Would you actually go see a movie a studio once tried to bury - or does that PR damage stick?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://collider.com/coyote-vs-acme-release-date-august-28/>

■ **'Obsession' Just Broke Hollywood's Sequel Curse**

The Angle: In a decade dominated by reboots, remakes, and franchise sequels, a totally original movie just crossed the \$500 million mark worldwide — the first one to pull it off since 2020. That's a genuinely rare box office feat worth talking about.

- **'Obsession'** is being called the **first original film of the 2020s** to gross **\$500 million** worldwide
- No franchise, no built-in fanbase, no existing IP — just an original story pulling in blockbuster numbers

The Debate Starter

- Does this prove audiences are hungry for something NEW, or is this just the exception that proves the sequel rule?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

■ **Nolan's *Odyssey* just became his biggest movie ever**

The Angle: Christopher Nolan just topped his own record — this ancient Greek epic outgrossed *Oppenheimer* and every Batman movie he's ever made, proving his star-power brand of blockbuster filmmaking is still untouchable.

- **The *Odyssey*** has crossed **\$1.4 billion** at the global box office
- That officially makes it **Christopher Nolan's** highest-grossing film ever, surpassing ***Oppenheimer***
- The film is Nolan's take on **Homer's** ancient Greek epic, with a stacked ensemble cast including **Matt Damon, Tom Holland, Anne Hathaway** and **Zendaya**

The Debate Starter

- Is Nolan officially the last director alive who can get people off the couch and into a theater — and who's next in line for that title?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://seat42f.com/the-odyssey-1-4-billion-christopher-nolan-box-office/>

Backup options:

■ **Crystal Harris: 'I Was Brainwashed' at the Mansion**

The Angle: Another ex-Playboy Mansion resident is speaking out about the psychological grip Hugh Hefner had on the women living there — a storyline that's kept pulling in audiences since the 'Secrets of Playboy' wave of exposés.

- **Crystal Harris**, Hugh Hefner's former fiancée and last live-in girlfriend, says she was '**absolutely brainwashed**' while living at the **Playboy Mansion**.
- Her comments add to a growing string of former Playmates and girlfriends publicly reassessing life inside the Mansion in recent years.

The Debate Starter

- How does someone get so deep into a controlling situation like that before they realize it - and what does it take to finally see it?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://ew.com/crystal-harris-says-she-was-brainwashed-at-playboy-mansion-12062036>

■ **Todd Bridges: *Diff'rent Strokes* Cast Got Hate Mail For Being Friends**

The Angle: A 1980s sitcom about a mixed-race family sounds wholesome now, but Todd Bridges says the real-life backlash behind the scenes was ugly - a reminder of how loaded the show actually was for its time.

The Then-vs-Now Check

- Ask listeners: what's a beloved old TV show that was way more controversial in its day than people remember?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.complex.com/pop-culture/a/bernadette-giacomazzo/todd-bridges-diffrent-strokes-hate-mail>

■■ **Drag Show Trolls *Turning Point USA* — With a JD Vance Couch Joke**

The Angle: A charity drag show mocking *Turning Point USA* raised money for the ACLU, but the bit everyone's talking about leaned straight into the infamous (and fake) JD Vance couch meme — pure internet-meets-politics comedy.

- The event's parody name was "**Turning Point USGay**" — a direct jab at **Turning Point USA**
- Proceeds from the drag show benefited the **ACLU**
- The reported highlight of the night: a bit centered on the viral **JD Vance couch** meme

The Debate Starter

- Is roasting the Vice President with a year-old internet meme clever satire, or has that joke officially expired?
Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD
URL: <https://v.redd.it/nhskezwnn5lh1>
-

■ **Zara Larsson loses it watching fans nail her dance**

The Angle: Fans went viral recreating the choreography from Zara Larsson's 'Midnight Sun,' and her reaction — cracking up mid-performance — is the kind of feel-good, watch-it-twice clip that spreads fast online.

- **Zara Larsson** performed her track 'Midnight Sun' live.
- Fans have been recreating the song's **iconic choreography** online.
- **Larsson** burst into laughter on stage watching them do it.

The Reaction Watch

- Have you or your friends ever tried to nail a viral dance challenge - and did it go as well as you hoped?
Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD
URL: <https://v.redd.it/ohnjqt7p16lh1>
-

TRENDING TODAY

■ **Idaho teens go viral cleaning up a river they were just diving in**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): These teens already command a built-in audience of nearly 200,000 Instagram followers, so this isn't starting from zero — it's a hand-off from an existing engaged community into a wholesome cleanup narrative that plays perfectly on video.

The Angle: A group of Idaho teens built almost 200,000 Instagram followers just documenting their summer, then their river cleanup video blew up online and turned into a real, ongoing mission - it's the kind of Gen-Z-does-good story that restores your faith in kids these days.

- **Eight teenagers** from Idaho run a shared Instagram account that's racked up nearly **200,000 followers** chronicling their summer
- They were diving in the **Boise River** for fun when they stumbled on piles of trash underwater
- They filmed a cleanup video that **went viral**, and instead of stopping, they kept coming back day after day
- What started as a random discovery has turned into a recurring, community-driven cleanup effort

The Feel-Good Debate

- Would your friend group turn a random gross discovery into a daily mission, or is this proof kids today actually care more than we give them credit for?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.ktvb.com/article/news/local/outreach/sevens-hero/7s-hero-teenagers-viral-fame-cleaning-boise-river/277-fe9dfb8b-4d63-482e-86a0-7d490ba0d273>

Backup options:

■ **Flock's CEO says 'let's compromise' as privacy backlash explodes**

The Angle: Flock's license-plate cameras have quietly ended up in thousands of communities nationwide, and now the backlash over surveillance and data access is loud enough that the CEO is publicly asking critics to meet in the middle - a genuine privacy-vs-safety flashpoint most listeners have a camera near their own street for.

- **Flock Safety** is the surveillance company at the center of the story - its license-plate reading cameras are used widely by law enforcement.
- **Flock's CEO** is publicly calling for '**compromise**' rather than fighting critics head-on.
- The company is facing **growing backlash** over how its surveillance network and data access are being used.

The Debate Starter

- Where's the line for you - smart public safety tool, or your daily drive getting logged without asking?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/23/flock-ceo-calls-for-compromise-as-surveillance-company-faces-growing-backlash/>

■ 90 Day Fiancé's Paula just torched Thomas on camera

The Angle: Another 90 Day Fiancé blowup is going viral, and Paula's savage insult of Thomas is the kind of reality TV trainwreck moment that gets clipped and shared everywhere - perfect fodder for a quick pop-culture hit.

- Paula has officially hit her breaking point with co-star Thomas on the show
- She reportedly called him an 'annoying son of a bitch' on camera
- The clash is the latest flashpoint in their rocky 90 Day Fiancé storyline

The Reality TV Roast

- What's the most savage insult you've ever heard on reality TV - and did it make you love or hate the person who said it?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/08/23/entertainment/90-day-fiance-paula-brutally-drags-thomas-as-an-annoying-son-of-a-bitch/>

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ A Nigerian researcher has made more than 2.8 million affordable sanitary pads from banana fiber and agricultural waste, reaching over 70,000 women and girls since 2021 while reducing plastic waste. He just won a \$100,000 Global Citizen award to scale the work.

The Angle: A Nigerian researcher has made more than 2.8 million affordable sanitary pads from banana fiber and agricultural waste, reaching over 70,000 women and girls since 2021 while reducing plastic waste. He just won a \$100,000 Global Citizen award to scale the work.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.globalcitizen.org/en/enquiries/press/2026/global-citizen-and-the-waislitz-foundation-announce-recipients-of/>

Backup options:

■ Golf brand yanks video after fans call it violent toward women

The Angle: A golf content brand pulled one of its own videos after backlash that it depicted violence against women - it's the classic brand-misfire moment that gets people arguing about intent versus impact.

- Good Good Golf pulled a video from circulation after online criticism.
- Critics said the clip depicted violence against women.
- The takedown itself became the story, spreading in "you won't believe this" corners of the internet like r/nottheonion.

The Debate Starter

- Overreaction or the right call - should brands pull content the second backlash starts, or ride it out?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://apnews.com/article/good-good-golf-callaway-ad-deleted-d970a76f06c4577a532ea2a572576c49>

■ Turns Out There's No 'Right Age' Script for Love Anymore

The Angle: This one's a mirror for half the audience — singles in their 30s and 40s aren't chasing one cookie-cutter relationship goal anymore, and moving in together is beating the ring. Great fuel for hosts to compare notes on what their own friend groups actually want.

- New research looked at **unmarried adults in their 30s and 40s** and found their relationship goals are all over the map — no single 'ideal' path.
- **Cohabitation** is now more popular than marriage among this group.
- Researchers say **past relationships and life events** — not age or tradition — shape what people want next.

The Debate Starter

- Team 'Move In First' or Team 'Ring Before Roommate' — where do you land, and why?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.psypost.org/single-adults-in-early-midlife-often-prefer-cohabitation-over-marriage/>

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ **LinkedIn Made An 'AI Slop' Button And We Broke It**

***The Angle:** LinkedIn added a way to flag posts as "AI slop," and people have smashed that button over a million times already — proof everyone's feed is drowning in fake motivational stories and robotic humblebrags.*

- The **"Seems like AI slop"** flag on **LinkedIn** has been clicked over **1 million times**.
- It's become the internet's new favorite way to call out obviously AI-written posts.

The Confession Booth

- Be honest — have you ever posted something on LinkedIn you're pretty sure sounded like a robot wrote it?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Real Person or AI Slop?** - 60-second live game -> One host reads three suspiciously inspirational LinkedIn posts out loud, the other guesses which ones were AI-generated.

- **Step 2: Worst Offender Vote** - Quick banter -> Hosts riff on the cringiest LinkedIn cliché — humblebrag, fake vulnerability post, or 'unpopular opinion' bait — and crown one champion.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.techspot.com/news/113580-people-have-clicked-like-ai-slop-button-linkedin.html>

Backup options:

✈️ ■ **Thailand's queen is out here training in fighter jets**

***The Angle:** Queen Suthida of Thailand reportedly logging time on an advanced Gripen fighter jet is exactly the kind of real-life-is-stranger-than-fiction royal headline that lands in r/nottheonion for a reason.*

- **Queen Suthida** of Thailand is undergoing **advanced flight training** on the **Gripen fighter jet**
- The **Gripen** is a Swedish-made multirole fighter used by several air forces worldwide
- Story surfaced via **r/nottheonion**, the subreddit for real news that reads like satire

The Watercooler Wow

- A literal queen training in a fighter jet cockpit - are royals allowed to be this cool now?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.straitstimes.com/asia/se-asia/thai-queen-suthida-undergoes-advanced-gripen-fighter-flight-training>

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ **Sullivan for Sullivan against Sullivan? Alaska's got a ballot problem**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The headline is a self-contained joke that requires no context to enjoy, which is exactly the kind of absurdist one-liner that gets screenshotted and shared without anyone reading the article.

***The Angle:** Multiple candidates named Sullivan are apparently on the same Alaska ballot, and it's gotten so tangled that one Sullivan is out here endorsing a Sullivan over a Sullivan - the kind of only-in-Alaska headline that writes its own punchline.*

The Tongue-Twister Test

- Try saying 'Sullivan endorses Sullivan against Sullivan' three times fast on air and see who survives.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.newsnationnow.com/politics/sullivan-endorses-sullivan-against-sullivan-alaska/>

■ **Sex Toys Just Turned Up In Iowa's Governor's Race**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The pun-driven headline about sex toys and a governor's race is inherently clickable and shareable purely on wordplay, independent of the actual regulatory-filing substance.

***The Angle:** A statewide election getting tangled up with sex toys via federal filings is exactly the kind of 'you can't make this up' headline that jumps from Reddit to national chatter fast - it's got the absurdity factor that makes it a classic weird-news watercooler story.*

The 'Wait, What?' Moment

- Ask listeners: what's the strangest thing you've ever seen buried in a public filing or disclosure?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.bleedingheartland.com/2026/06/01/sex-toys-penetrate-iowa-governors-race-context-from-federal-regulatory-filings/>

■ **New compound melts fat, keeps your muscle — for real?**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A fat-loss compound that preserves muscle hits the exact anxiety GLP-1/Ozempic users are voicing right now, putting it directly in the path of an already-raging cultural conversation.

***The Angle:** Everyone's obsessed with weight-loss shortcuts right now thanks to Ozempic and friends, and this one claims to dodge the biggest complaint — losing muscle along with the fat. That's the exact debate the internet is already having.*

The Debate Starter

- Would you try an experimental fat-burning compound before it's fully proven safe, or wait it out?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.sciencedaily.com/releases/2026/08/260823014953.htm>

■ **Harvard's Now Selling AI Clones of Its Professors**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Harvard selling AI-clone-taught courses is a surprising, slightly unsettling angle on higher ed's AI pivot that combines a trusted brand name with an easy 'is this where education is headed' hook.

***The Angle:** Ivy League prestige meets AI hustle culture - Harvard Business School is charging real money for a course where the "professor" isn't even a real person, and that collision is exactly the kind of AI-replacing-humans story everyone's already primed to argue about.*

- **Harvard Business School** built a new entrepreneurship bootcamp using **A.I. avatars** of its own faculty
- Price tag on the course: **\$699**

- The AI clones are designed to teach in place of the actual professors

The Debate Starter

- Would you pay \$699 to be taught by an AI version of a professor instead of the real thing?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.nytimes.com/2026/08/22/business/dealbook/harvard-ai-faculty.html?smid=nytcore-ios-share>

■ MIT turned bacteria into living computer chips

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): 'Living transistors' made of bacteria is a genuinely novel, almost sci-fi sounding breakthrough from a big-name institution (MIT) that reads as unbelievable enough to make people want to verify and share it.

The Angle: *Scientists engineered bacteria to act like transistors, the building blocks of computers - it's the kind of 'wait, WHAT?' science headline that makes people picture actual living computers, and it taps into the same fascination/unease people have with AI and biotech blurring lines right now.*

The Wait, What? Reaction

- Ask listeners: does 'living computer chips made of bacteria' sound like the coolest thing you've heard all week, or straight-up nightmare fuel?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://news.mit.edu/2026/mit-engineers-connect-bacteria-to-create-living-transistors-0817>

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)
- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground <https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt> <https://t.co/HwXL2>" (X/Twitter @NYPPost, banked 2026-08-13)
- "Hayden Panettiere was haunted by crippling back pain from bizarre on-set zebra accident" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-19)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 16 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
- "Anniversary of copybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: 'Disappointed'" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
- "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
- "'Roseanne' Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
- "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal's Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "'Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)
- "Ugly inning, quiet bats doom Yankees in disappointing loss to Blue Jays" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-14)
- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she's sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)
- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to 'The Fast and the Furious' 25th Anniversary Screening in LA <https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg>" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)

- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt 'Disappointed' by BLACKPINK's 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)
 - "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
 - "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite's 'Override' Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)
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SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/futurology (no posts cleared the 300+ upvotes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

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